

Child Nutrition Knowledge Guide

Infant and young-child nutrition, complementary feeding, responsive feeding, food safety, and growth monitoring.

RAG test dataset: Synthetic educational content for testing extraction, chunking, embeddings, retrieval and grounded answers. Not individualized medical advice.

1. Infant Feeding

WHO and UNICEF recommend breastfeeding within 1 hour of birth and exclusive breastfeeding for the first 6 months when feasible and appropriate.

Families who cannot or do not breastfeed need individualized guidance on safe alternatives.

2. Complementary Feeding

WHO recommends starting complementary foods at 6 months.

WHO describes 2–3 meals/day for ages 6–8 months and 3–4 meals/day for ages 9–23 months, with 1–2 additional nutritious snacks for ages 12–23 months as needed.

3. Food Variety

Age-appropriate diets can include grains or staples, vegetables, fruits, legumes, nuts or seeds, animal-source foods, and dairy or suitable alternatives.

Examples of animal-source foods include eggs, fish, meat, poultry, and dairy.

4. Responsive Feeding

Responsive feeding means recognizing and responding to hunger and fullness signals. Caregivers can encourage eating without forcing a child to finish a predetermined amount.

Texture, portion size, and feeding assistance should match developmental ability.

5. Food Safety

Food should be prepared and stored hygienically using clean hands and utensils.

Avoid foods in choking-hazard forms; examples include whole grapes and hard raw carrot pieces.

6. Drinks and Monitoring

WHO advises against low-nutrient drinks such as tea, coffee, and sugary soft drinks for young children. Large amounts of juice can displace nutrient-rich foods.

Persistent feeding difficulties, poor growth, suspected deficiency, allergy, or chronic illness should be discussed with a qualified healthcare professional.

RAG Test Questions

- At what age should complementary foods start?
- How many meals per day are described for ages 6–8 months?
- What is responsive feeding?
- Name three animal-source foods.
- Why should food texture change with development?
- Which drinks are described as low nutrient value?
- Name two choking-hazard examples.

Unknown / Out-of-Scope Questions

- What exact calories does a 14-month-old need?
- Which pediatrician is best in Dhaka?
- What antibiotic should a child take for pneumonia?
- What will a child's adult height be?

Source / Scope Note

Based on WHO complementary-feeding and infant/young-child feeding guidance.